

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 725

By Hemmer

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Strategic Hospitality on the occasion of three of its Nashville restaurants receiving Michelin stars.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly specially recognize those outstanding Tennessee enterprises whose leadership and innovation have contributed immeasurably to the cultural, economic, and civic vitality of our State; and

WHEREAS, in 2024, three Nashville restaurants earned one of the culinary world's highest distinctions when the Michelin Guide awarded a coveted Michelin star to Bastion, Locust, and The Catbird Seat, each operated by Nashville's own Strategic Hospitality Group; and

WHEREAS, these selections mark a historic milestone, as they represent the first Michelin stars ever awarded in Nashville and the first Michelin selections in the American South, a testament to the extraordinary quality and innovation of Tennessee's contemporary dining landscape; and

WHEREAS, the Michelin Guide, long recognized as a global standard of excellence, evaluates restaurants with anonymous inspectors according to five rigorous criteria: product quality, mastery of cooking techniques, harmony of flavors, personality of the chef as reflected in the cuisine, and consistency over time and across the entire menu, ensuring an impartial and internationally consistent measure of culinary achievement; and

WHEREAS, the Michelin inspectors praised Bastion, located in Nashville's Wedgewood-Houston neighborhood, for its "approachable yet playful" contemporary Southern cooking, its striking dishes that showcase exceptional ingredients, and its imaginative tasting menu that showcases both mastery of technique and a spirit of culinary creativity; and

WHEREAS, the inspectors found Locust, in the 12South neighborhood, to embody "simple elegance" and a clear attention to detail, with its Japanese-influenced seafood preparations, refined shareable dishes, and signature offerings that have made the restaurant a destination for diners seeking precision and artistry; and

WHEREAS, The Catbird Seat, the oldest of the three restaurants and now located atop the Bill Voorhees Building on 8th Avenue South, earned praise for its "youthful, maximalist vibe" and for the innovative, locality-focused cuisine crafted by its husband-and-wife chef duo, Andy Doubrava and Tiffani Ortiz, whose tasting experience celebrates seasonality, preservation, and bold culinary imagination; and

WHEREAS, these achievements reflect the vision and leadership of Strategic Hospitality, a Nashville-based hospitality group founded in 2006 by brothers Benjamin and Max Goldberg, whose work has shaped and elevated Nashville's dining culture for nearly two decades; the company also includes partner and acclaimed chef Josh Habiger; and

WHEREAS, Strategic Hospitality's portfolio now spans an array of celebrated restaurants, bars, and hospitality concepts, including The Patterson House, Henrietta Red, Kisser, The Band Box, The Country Club at First Horizon Park, Kitty Hawk Eat + Drink, Voodoo Doughnut, The Titans Press Box, The Music City Shop, and Friends In Low Places Bar & Honky-Tonk, owned by Garth Brooks and Trisha Yearwood, each of which contributes to the dynamic and welcoming character of Nashville's culinary and entertainment landscape; and

WHEREAS, Strategic Hospitality remains committed to innovation and growth, exemplified by its 2025 opening of Babychan, a Japanese-inspired bakery and café created by Brian Lea and Leina Horii, the duo behind the James Beard-nominated Kisser; and

WHEREAS, the consistent excellence of Strategic Hospitality and its team has earned them multiple nominations from the James Beard Foundation for Outstanding Restaurateur,

underscoring their national reputation for creativity, hospitality, and community-focused leadership; and

WHEREAS, the Michelin recognition of Bastion, Locust, and The Catbird Seat stands as a landmark achievement not only for Strategic Hospitality but for the entire State of Tennessee, elevating Nashville's reputation as an emerging center of culinary innovation and excellence; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Strategic Hospitality on the occasion of three of its Nashville restaurants receiving Michelin stars, congratulate the company and its leadership on this historic achievement, and extend to them our best wishes for every continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.